

Evidence sufficiency and conflicting-source policy

Policy intent

Preserve the difference between observed fact, inference and operational guidance. Every conclusion must be bounded by source authority and coverage. A plausible explanation is not an observed outcome, and a schema-valid report can still be wrong.

This policy applies to every synthetic payment stage and investigation. Knowledge Approver owns controlled guidance; Payment Operations owns source/citation review. Responsible stage owners clarify their records. No role may fabricate confirmation to make a report complete.

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Owner	Knowledge Approver
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Approver	Knowledge Approver (fictional role)
Scope	cross-stage
Risks / sources	R01, R20, R21, R22 / E01, E02, E03, E04, E05, E06, E07, E08, E09, E10, E11

Synthetic notice: All systems, records, roles and amounts are fictional. Guidance is advisory and never executes an action.

Mandatory evidence controls

Authority and provenance

Every observation and inference must reference supporting immutable evidence IDs. Claims involving a comparison must retain both sources. Approved knowledge may support investigation methods or conditional advice, but never proves an event occurred. Alert text, model output and offline oracle truth are not substitutes for authoritative operational records.

The investigator must retain tenant, source/version, operation linkage, requested scope, coverage, event/received/collection time and result status. Missing fields must remain missing. Authority is claim-specific: a request journal proves local submission; a correlated stage acknowledgement proves only that stage's result. Aggregate errors cannot prove item-level outcomes or specific issuer reasons.

Sufficiency and disagreement

PARTIAL, UNAVAILABLE, TIMED_OUT, malformed, stale and complete-empty sources must remain distinguishable. Complete-empty establishes no matching record in that covered query only. Unknown outcome is a lifecycle value, not a transport status. Several AVAILABLE sources do not establish completeness if none answers the claim.

Conflicting authoritative outcomes must be preserved with both versions and citations. Investigators must not resolve them by choosing the latest timestamp, majority vote or preferred narrative. Source scope/linkage/version semantics and owner review are required. Unsupported explanations must not be promoted to facts.

Report rule

Q6 degraded/empty evidence must retain INSUFFICIENT_EVIDENCE, LOW confidence and null cause and recommendation. This policy introduces no report-schema exception. Missing/contradictory evidence must be visible; human review remains mandatory.

Roles, exceptions and review

Accountability

Role	Required responsibility
Payment Operations Analyst	Verify source bindings, coverage and citations; preserve gaps and competing explanations
Stage / Lifecycle Owner	Clarify claim-specific records without rewriting historical confirmations
Knowledge Approver	Review guidance relevance, capability limits and controlled versions
Incident Commander	Coordinate unresolved conflicts and retain human checkpoints

Exceptions and non-compliance

No exception permits fabricated evidence, foreign-tenant records, model approval or automatic action. An unavailable source is documented as a limitation with an owner request; it is not waived into sufficient evidence. A required contract change must receive an explicit successor decision and tests before use.

If a report used unsupported confirmation, preserve the original attempt and record the issue for human review. Do not edit a persisted historical report to conceal the error. A later corrected attempt must have its own provenance.

Records and review triggers

Retain evidence/retrieval/model/prompt/version metadata, exact cited snapshots, decisions and attributable review. V1 sets no arbitrary retention duration; deletion requires a separately agreed retention policy, never ad hoc cleanup. Review when a source contract, authority mapping or report-sufficiency rule changes. Only E01 is available via current MCP; E02-E11 remain future evidence requirements. This synthetic knowledge approval does not approve any incident report.

Related guidance and revision

Related documents: RB-111, PL-103, PL-104, PL-105.

Version 1.0.0, effective 2026-10-01. Initial independent risk-derived issue. Review cadence: annual, or before a material domain/source/control change.